

Redis Maxclients Postmortem

Incident: order-service Redis connection timeout and 5xx spike.

Incident window: 2026-07-06 10:00-10:18 UTC.

Evidence: connected_clients=9940, maxclients=10000, blocked_clients=37.

Prometheus showed 5xx and P95 latency rising during the same window.

Loki logs showed Redis timeout and connection-pool wait messages.

Root cause: Redis client capacity was exhausted by retry amplification.

Remediation boundary: increasing maxclients, restarting Redis, or changing pool settings requires human approval and a production change window.